

Security at AI Speed - A Note to the Head of Threat Intelligence

1. Why This Matters to You

Threat intelligence is no longer a product you publish. It is one of three entry points — alongside red teaming and detection — into a single, continuously updated picture of where this organization can actually be hurt. Attackers now move from reconnaissance to consequence in minutes, which means external signal only has value if it changes our posture *before* the attacker is fully inside. Anything that arrives later is narration. Your accountability is no longer the quality of the report. It is the speed at which what you see outside becomes a defensible decision inside. If your function still runs on quarterly briefings and threat encyclopedias, it is operationally invisible — regardless of how good the analysis is.

2. The Core Problem

Security used to assume time existed between detection, decision, and action. It does not. The bottleneck has moved from control coverage to decision latency and authority. A mature-looking program can still be too slow to matter. For threat intelligence specifically, the failure is twofold: signal is produced in isolation from the live estate, so exploitability is unknown; and it arrives on a cadence that the attacker does not respect. Generic threat reporting against an unknown internal exposure is theater. The leadership question is no longer "what do we know about the adversary," but "what did we change because of what we know, and how fast."

3. What You Must Own

- **One fused threat view, not three teams.** Threat intelligence, red teaming, and detection must produce a single, prioritized picture of exposure and consequence — the same view the CISO, operations, and the board work from. Different reports are a structural defect.
- **Decision-ready output, not encyclopedia entries.** Every item you surface must come with: validated exploitability against this estate, the attack path, the business service at risk, the proposed action, and the time-box for the decision.
- **The full breadth of signal.** Strategic, geopolitical, business, regulatory, and technical intelligence — fused. Adversary motivation and a Common Vulnerabilities and Exposures identifier belong on the same page. Leadership cannot triage these in separate forums.
- **Connecting outside to inside.** External threat evolution must be continuously mapped to internal exploitability. If we cannot say whether a given technique works against us today, the intelligence is incomplete.
- **The bi-weekly decision loop.** Your function operates *inside* the integrated threat briefing, not adjacent to it. You enter the room with decisions to be made, not slides to be reviewed.
- **Operational collective defense.** Pre-cleared sharing channels, pre-agreed legal basis, pre-authorized authority to consume and contribute signal at tempo. Ceremonial information-sharing relationships do not reduce attacker advantage.

4. What Must Change Now

- **From reporting to deciding.** Your output is no longer a publication. It is a queue of time-boxed

decisions for the CISO and the leadership team — what must be stopped today, what must be fixed in days, what is consciously accepted.

- **From standalone team to integrated function.** Dismantle the line between threat intelligence, red team, and hunting outputs. One backlog, one prioritization, one truth — whether internal or sourced from providers.
- **From cadence-driven to event-driven.** Material change in threat or exposure triggers the loop. Quarterly rhythm becomes the floor for posture review, not the ceiling for action.
- **From "interesting" to "exploitable here."** Drop items that cannot be tied to this estate's identities, services, or data. They consume attention you do not have.
- **From private signal to shared signal.** Move the legal, contractual, and authority work needed for real-time exchange with peers, providers, and authorities to the front of the program — before the next event, not during it.

5. The One Question to Take into your Leadership Team

"If we receive a high-confidence external signal at 03:00 that a technique now in active use can reach a critical service of ours — who already has the authority to act on it before sunrise, and what is the longest acceptable delay we are willing to own?"

If that question cannot be answered today, threat intelligence is producing knowledge the organization cannot convert into protection.